understand Modi’s embrace of the United States and his broader foreign policy trajectory.

Conclusion

This chapter explicated the trajectory of Indo–US relations under the Modi government. Modi’s assumption of power in 2014 confronted his government with two major issues in the Indo–US relationship. It had to first arrest the downward spiral in the bilateral relationship during the UPA-II government, and, second, it had to overcome the complications engendered by America’s decade-old visa policy on Narendra Modi. Modi was guided by pragmatism in addressing both these challenges. Even as his government focused on resolving the outstanding bilateral issues on nuclear liability and defence cooperation with the United States, Modi’s personal experience of a US visa ban was put aside. There was also a policy realignment insofar as the Modi government appears keener to be a part of US strategy in Asia-Pacific. Unlike UPA-II, which remained ambivalent on China’s assertiveness in the Asian region, Modi appears to acknowledge that India needs to actively balance China’s growing power by cooperating closely with Washington, DC. Three factors explain this policy shift: the Prime Minister’s personal conviction that India’s developmental priorities cannot be met without substantive cooperation with the United States, the strong political authority Prime Minister Modi enjoys within his own party and in the lower house of the Indian Parliament, and the structural changes in India’s security environment brought about by a more powerful and aggressive China and its growing strategic convergence with Pakistan.